

A Prayer during temptation, and a renewal of baptismal vows.

Lord Jesus Christ!
My whole being belongs to Thee,
From the top of my head to the tips of my
toes:
My brain and heart, soul and nous
My arms and hands, legs and feet,
All of my senses,
And all of my thoughts and actions.

Take away any authority Satan has over me,

*(various addictions and sins can be mentioned
here)*

and unite my whole self to Thee.

And by Thy grace, I renew my baptismal
pledges to renounce Satan, and all his works, and
all his angels, and all his service, and all his pride,
and to from this moment struggle to unite my
whole self to Thee.

Amen.

One may modify this prayer to be very personal about the ways in which Satan has enslaved you. For example (specify anything that is an ongoing problem for you), "Take away any authority Satan has over me... such as my negative thoughts, and anger, and abuse of alcohol, and looking at pornography and doing unclean things, and anxiety and depression and despondency..."

We should also specify any body parts which participate in the sin, or just as the prayer does, give a semi-comprehensive list of parts of the body and actions of the soul.

This prayer was given to me by a father at St. Anthony's Greek Orthodox Monastery, in Arizona. Once a former warlock deeply involved in occultic and satanic things visited the monastery. The man had repented of such terrible things and was baptized, but there were still sometimes temptations (because even though Satan was defeated, he acts like a bully who still yells at someone who stood up to him from across the playground), so he spontaneously came up with the prayer just like this.

He told that father how powerfully the prayer worked for him. And, no matter who we are, we are attacked by demons, and the prayer works for anyone who says it with all the heart. I use it myself.

I advise anyone to say this prayer, daily as part of their rule, and also, especially when they have some problem with sin and passions, whether it be an ongoing addiction or some terrible, unclean sin, or even just problems with pride and irritation and laziness, etc.

Every time we sin, we are reneging on our baptismal vows, and every sin we commit gives Satan rights over us. We allow him to dominate us to a greater or lesser extent because of our sins and passions, but his dominance is lessened by repentance, and completely nullified when we complete our repentance with God's grace.

How should you use this prayer? As mentioned above, when you are severely tempted, say the prayer, either exactly as written or however you wish to say it, from memory. You can also use it as I use it, by adding it to your morning rule. I recommend both usages. You may print off the prayer in any "card" form, by downloading this file. If you printed you can cut it into quarters and it will easily fit in the prayer book or your wallet, etc.

I like this prayer because it is useful during a time of temptation, and it's easy to remember, and also it reminds us that we are oath-breakers when we sin. We gave an oath to God that we would renounce Satan and all of his works, and all of his service, and all of his pride, and also to cleave (only) to Christ. Every time we sin, we are breaking our oath. May God forgive us and help us to no longer be oath-breakers. Remember that no matter what our sin, ardent and honest repentance will always, in addition to moving God to forgive us our sin, also give us power to completely overcome it and obliterate it.

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